

Setting

Near future, year 2175, planet Earth.

The story takes place in a modern underwater chemical-technological laboratory in a dilapidated, emergency condition.

The Laboratory

The laboratory was created by the SynD corporation in 2132 with the goal of establishing the best research center in the world. According to the original concept, the entire scientific staff consists of cyborgs — robots containing the brains of humanity's greatest scientists.

To bring this idea to life, the corporation launched the "Digital Genius" program. Over five years, scientists from all over the world were invited and offered the opportunity to create a digital copy of their brains. In return, they would receive a percentage of the laboratory's profits.

In reality, the scientists' brains were cloned, after which biological weapons were implanted into their bodies, killing all participants five years after the launch of the program.

This manipulation allowed the corporation to establish a monopoly on science — since the robots contain actual human brains, they cannot be hacked and their information cannot be stolen. Effectively, the scientists became trapped inside the laboratory while remaining unaware of it, as all communication channels are artificial and video calls are generated using deepfakes.

Synopsis

Year 2175. An underwater laboratory where robots with digitized consciousnesses of the world's greatest scientists work tirelessly. For 30 years they have functioned using Valladium — a newly discovered chemical element found at this station. Besides being an energy source, its isotopes can alter the physical properties of objects.

During the research, a new isotope is created — Valladium-5, an unstable substance that rapidly spreads and causes unstoppable accelerated aging in all materials.

The laboratory, built mostly from metal, descends into chaos and despair: robots lose both their metallic bodies and human sanity. If the isotope's spread is not stopped, it will destroy the laboratory and escape into the outside world, causing a global catastrophe.

Immediately after the accident, the station's main computer calculated the approximate time before the isotope particles break free — 30 days.

After spending most of this time searching for a way to neutralize the isotope, the protagonist heads into the epicenter of the disaster to save what remains of the laboratory and the future of humanity before it is too late.

Linear Story Progression

Scene 1 — Workshop. Test Area

Master (muttering):

Almost ready... yes, almost ready!

Master (to the protagonist):

There, finished. Just look at this beauty.

Something like this makes that strange robo-body experiment worth it, right?

Now let's see whether our efforts paid off.

(after a pause, impatient and slightly offended)

Well? How long are you going to stand there?

Protagonist (Alex):

Are you sure this thing will work? I'm getting tired of waiting already.

Master (slightly mesmerized):

We'll test it, we'll test it — it should work!

After all, I didn't end up among the elite of the greatest scientists for nothing!

I can do a thing or two myself, even if I'm not one of those physicists everyone worships here. Heh-heh.

Master:

Now THAT is a cannon. A miracle cannon!

Will you give it a name? Like knights named their swords in the Middle Ages?

Protagonist (Alex):

I heard they call it the Atomizer. I like that.

Master:

You could've called it Excalibur... but alright, your choice...

(striking a dramatic pose)

Well then, Knight of the Atomizer, onward to glorious deeds!

But first, let's refuel with some premium Valladium.

Announcement System:

Attention! A state of emergency has occurred in the laboratory!

All personnel remain calm and proceed to the residential sector immediately!

Attention!

Residential Sector

Scene 1 — Protagonist's Room

Protagonist (Alex):

Hopefully today is the day this all finally ends...

Time to go. The others are probably waiting already.

Scene 2 — Corridor

Finn McCarthy:

So, ready? Finally... fi-na-lly!

(sighs lightly)

I hope everything goes smoothly and you reach the target.

(cheerfully again)

Ogawa has already prepared the communication system! Let's go.

Finn McCarthy:

Seriously, it wasn't easy setting this system up.

But now it works like a Swiss watch! We tested it from different points in the residential zone — everything works!

Protagonist (Alex):

That's good. Too bad the lack of communication with other survivors isn't our only problem.

Finn McCarthy:

Yeah, and there's that damned corrosion too!

But hopefully you can handle it. SynD poured plenty of money into our bodies, right?

Top-grade materials. They don't decay easily... unless you end up in the middle of those particles, of course.

Protagonist (Alex):

That's exactly why I'm heading to the workshop for equipment.

Scene 3 — Before the Atrium Exit

Finn McCarthy:

And here we are! Been waiting long?

Takeshi Ogawa:

(to Finn)

I have.

(to the Alex)

Glad you're ready! Take the radio — let's test it.

Protagonist (Alex):

Finn said it works perfectly.

Finn McCarthy:

Of course! Handcrafted by Ogawa himself. The Chinese sure know how to work, huh?

Takeshi Ogawa:

I'm Japanese.

Takeshi Ogawa:

I hear you.

Protagonist (Alex):

I hear you too.

Takeshi Ogawa:

Excellent. Finn and I already tested it over long distances as well.

I think you're ready to go.

Takeshi Ogawa:

We'll stay here, whisper poetry into your ear and give unsolicited advice.

Don't hesitate to ask for help yourself.

Protagonist (Alex):

Yeah, sure.

Takeshi Ogawa:

Now, to business.

As we remember, your objective is to reach the central laboratory and neutralize the Valladium isotope Valladium-5.

But in your current condition, you won't even get close — corrosion will dissolve you into the air.

So first, you need to reach the workshop and retrieve equipment that can coat your body with a protective layer.

Master already prepared everything. You just need to collect it.

Most of the station's systems are offline, chaos is everywhere, and many paths are blocked.

Your first destination is the medical sector. From there, you'll head to the workshop.

After obtaining protection, you can proceed to the storage facility and from there to the laboratory.

That's the plan for now.

Finn McCarthy:

If you find anything interesting — bring it to us!

(with slight hope in his voice)

And if you find anyone alive, send them our way too.

Protagonist (Alex):

Alright.

(exhales like before stepping on stage)

Well then... here we go.
(slightly ironic)
"Let's go," as the great ones used to say.

Medical Sector

Wards

Takeshi Ogawa:

Over there, to the left... that must be the passage to the Workshop. That's what we need.

Protagonist (Alex):

The mechanism doesn't work. Looks like it's missing a battery.

Finn McCarthy:

Not just a battery. The door is locked because of emergency protocols.

You'll also need a keycard from the main administration.

According to the report, a package was sent... but did it arrive?

Pneumatic Mail Station

Protagonist (Alex):

This is one of the pneumatic delivery stations.

Is that the keycard we need stuck in there?

Lounge

Finn McCarthy:

There used to be a fountain here.

Judging by the mess, it didn't help someone calm down.

Finding Battery

Finn McCarthy:

These batteries fit a lot of things, including door mechanisms.

In some ways, SynD is surprisingly practical.

Encounter with the Psycho and Obtaining Valladium-2

Psycho (William Rivers):

Pour it into yourself... ignite... become flame... decay...
Abandon thought... remain... and simply wait... until I crumble apart...

Protagonist (Alex) (quietly):

I need this. This will definitely come in handy.

Protagonist (Alex):

Looks like this is the Valladium-2 isotope.
I should return and install it into the Atomizer. It definitely won't hurt to have it.

Psycho (William Rivers):

You... decided for us...

Psycho (William Rivers):

You took our choice away! You had no right! It's ours! OURS!
WE should've decided! WE! Not you!

Finn McCarthy (shouting):

Run!

Psycho (William Rivers):

We'll take it back even if we have to tear you apart!

Finn McCarthy:

Run back to the exit! We'll close the door behind you!

Return to Residential Zone

Finn McCarthy:

There you are! Thank God you escaped from him!

Protagonist (Alex):

I can't believe such a transformation could happen to a scientist.
Didn't he mention creating Valladium-2?
I think that was William Rivers — wasn't he leading the development?

Takeshi Ogawa:

Anything can happen. But no living being should suffer like that.
The effects of corrosion truly are horrifying.

Finn McCarthy:

But now we can install the new isotope for you!

Finn McCarthy:

Done! Now you can switch isotopes whenever you want.
Go to the testing zone and see how it works.
In theory, the isotope should increase the temperature of objects.

Therapist's Office

Psycho (William Rivers):

This is where it all ends. You'll return what you stole.

Psycho (William Rivers):

Bastard! Monster! You're leaving us here to die slowly?!
Scum! ...NO!... No... you wouldn't dare...
I don't even know how long this will take. Please. No one else is coming.
No one can help me except you. Please... I don't want to just wait until I disappear...

Protagonist (Alex):

How could this happen... Such a brilliant scientist.
A mind like that shouldn't give in to panic.
A mind like that cannot die.
(more confidently, as if convincing himself)
I think everything will return to normal and we'll help him.
I believe that.

Takeshi Ogawa:

Yes. No one deserves this.
And the planet deserves even less the decay caused by Valladium-5.

Door Repair

Protagonist (Alex):

Finally! That door took forever to open.
I'm heading to the Workshop. Do you copy?

Finn McCarthy:

Genius!
(to the side)
Ogawa, did you hear that? Everything's going according to plan! Alex is heading to the Workshop!

Takeshi Ogawa:

Alex, I'm glad it worked out! Keep moving!